

Stress v Performance Curve Explanation in the Report

The stress/performance curve illustrates the relationship between performance (vertical scale) and stress (horizontal scale).

A certain level of pressure is needed to reach the 'sweet spot' of optimal performance, but prolonged pressure and stress may lead to exhaustion.

Remaining in the exhaustion phase over a long period of time causes performance to decline, and without the chance to reset, this can lead to illness or even burnout.

Burnout, as defined by the World Health Organisation as chronic workplace stress that hasn't been managed effectively. Illness is characterised by short periods of absence from work, whilst burnout is usually associated with extended periods of absence.

On the left side of the curve, you may feel 'bored' if the role doesn't test your capabilities. The 'challenged' phase can apply to those struggling to reach optimal performance, perhaps due to being new, unclear roles or priorities, or team conflict.

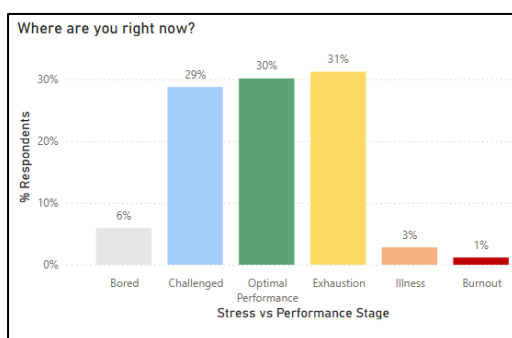
The following pages show the 6 stages of the Stress Performance Curve that may appear in an individual's report.

Note that this is a **self-assessment** at a moment in time. The report shows where the individual assesses themselves 'now' on the stress v performance curve.

Insights from the Stress v Performance Curve Data

When working with groups or teams, the distribution of the group across the stress v performance curve can provide us clear insights into the 'health' and well-being of the group.

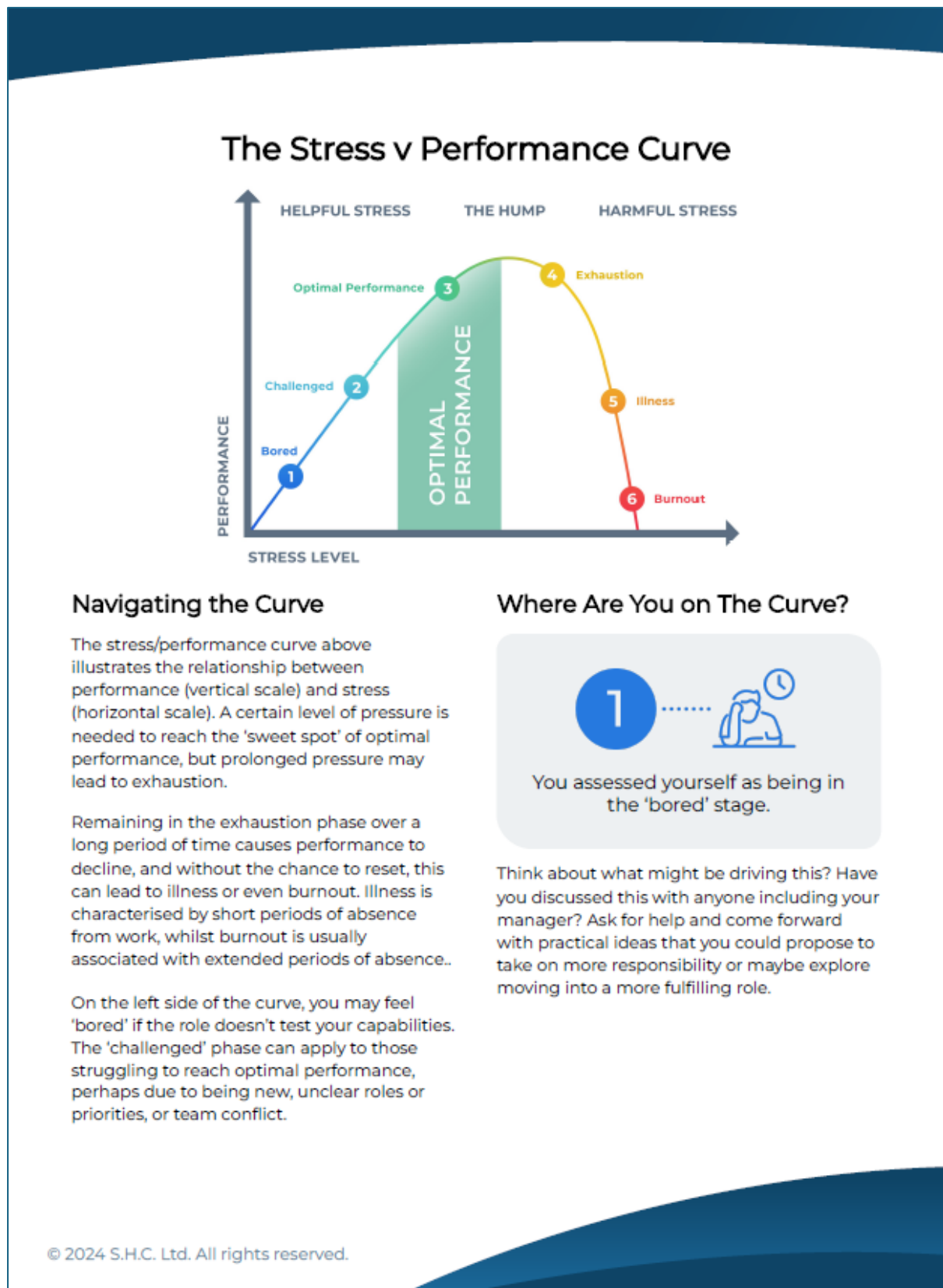
Our analytics show that typically 30% of people are in Optimal Performance, 29% challenged, 6% bored, 31% exhaustion, 3% illness, 1% burnout. (Based on data from 1,750 Assessments). For smaller samples, data distribution may vary significantly from this distribution.



Harmful stress is defined as people in the Exhaustion, Illness, Burnout categories which from the analytics below amount to 35% of the people.

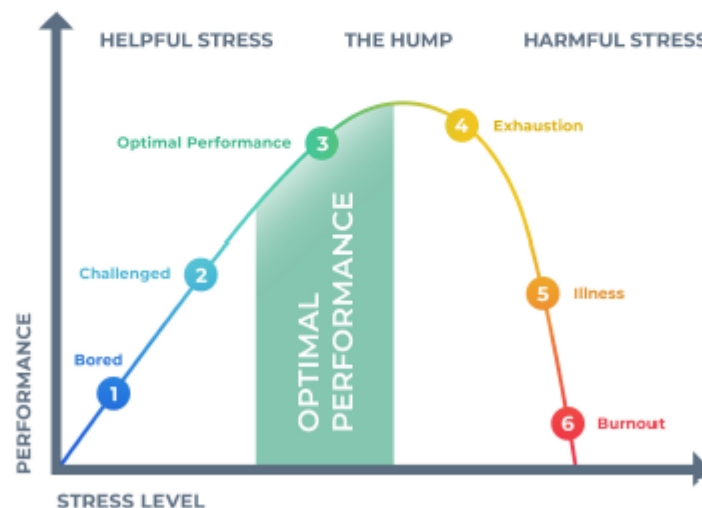
Report Wording for Each Stage of the Stress v Performance Curve

1. Bored



2. Challenged

The Stress v Performance Curve



Navigating the Curve

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Where Are You on The Curve?



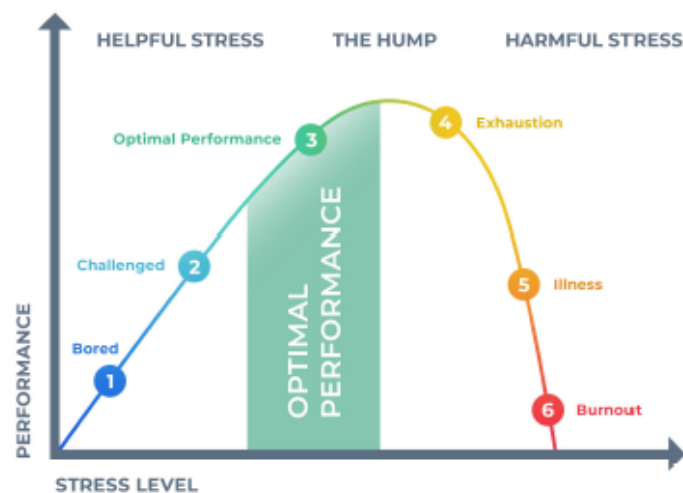
You assessed yourself as being in the 'challenged' stage.

Think about what you would need to do to get to the optimal performance level. What capabilities and skills would you need, what roadblocks would need to be removed, what clarity and support would help you get there.

Take the first step and discuss the situation openly with your manager and ask for help where required.

3. Optimal Performance

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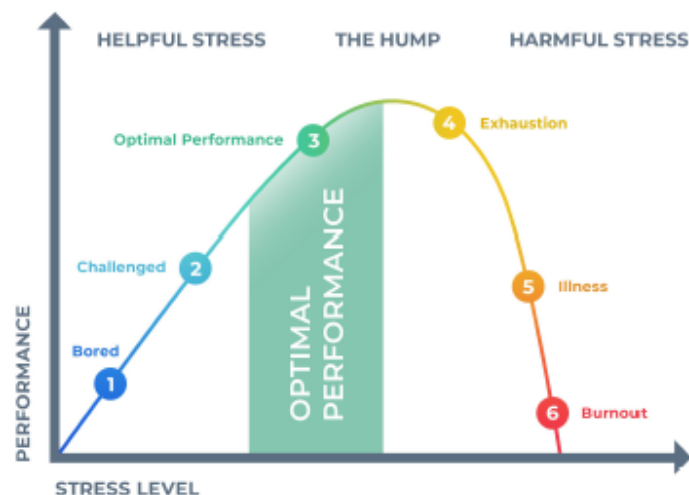


You assessed yourself as being in the 'optimal performance' stage.

Make sure that you continue to maintain the balance between high performance and acceptable levels of pressure and stress. If you experience periods of exhaustion, make sure that you take the time to recharge after a busy period of work or in your home life and look out for the early signs of stress and burnout.

4. Exhaustion

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You assessed yourself as being in the 'exhaustion' stage.

Think about how long you have felt this way and what are the likely causes. Is your workload too high causing you to regularly work in the evenings and weekends? Are you sacrificing other aspects of your life such as exercise, eating healthily, socialising or relaxing. Make adjustments to your routine and seek support from your manager to address some of the root causes in the workplace. By making the changes now, you can avoid moving to the illness phase.

5. Illness

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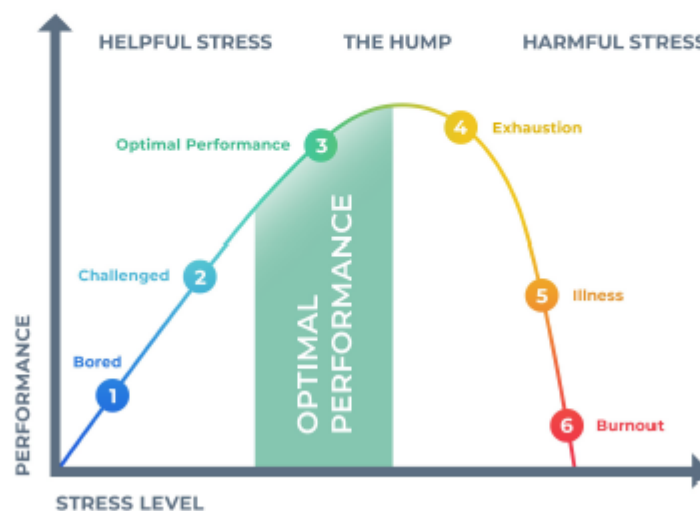


You assessed yourself as being in the 'illness' stage.

In this stage you are likely to be experiencing periods of illness and absence from work. It's not too late to seek help and support from your manager to address the likely causes of stress before the situation deteriorates further. You may also benefit from exploring professional help externally.

6. Burnout

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Where Are You on The Curve?



You assessed yourself as being in the 'burnout' stage.

Burnout arises from chronic, unmanaged workplace stress and is characterised by three dimensions: exhaustion, increased mental distance from one's job and reduced professional efficacy. The 5 major causes of burnout are: unfair treatment, unmanageable workload, unrealistic time pressures, lack of communication and support from managers and lack of role clarity. If you're experiencing burnout, it's crucial to consult your manager and HR and seek professional help.